

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-200-STEP Administration
	Document No./Name	P-210-STEP Administration
	Effective Date	March 1, 2021

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

P-211-STEP - PO ORGANIZATION OF THE STEP PROGRAM

The STEP program is designed so persons applying for services will have a similar experience when seeking those services at any Economic Stability (ES) office throughout the state.

P-212-STEP - PO INTAKE WORKFLOW

Work-eligible FITAP applicants enter the STEP program after they are certified for FITAP cash assistance.

P-213-STEP - PO STAFF DUTIES

The duties specific of the Intake Worker, the Case Maintenance Worker, and the STEP Case Management Worker are defined below.

Intake

The Intake Worker shall follow departmental procedures during the intake process while processing applications for SNAP, FITAP, and KCSP.

Case Maintenance

The Case Maintenance Worker shall follow departmental procedures during ongoing eligibility-related activities for SNAP, FITAP, and KCSP.

STEP Case Management

The STEP Coach, also known in LITE as the STEP Case Manager, shall follow departmental procedures during ongoing STEP case management.

II. PROCEDURES

P-211-STEP- PR ORGANIZATION OF THE STEP PROGRAM

There are no procedures associated with this policy.

P-212-STEP - PR INTAKE WORKFLOW

There are no procedures associated with this policy.

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P-213-STEP - PR STAFF DUTIES

Depending on the office size and organization of staff, some of these duties may overlap.

Intake

The Intake Worker is responsible for determining eligibility for FITAP and any associated KCSP and SNAP benefits.

During the intake process the applicant shall:

- be interviewed for FITAP, KCSP, and/or SNAP benefits.
- complete the Needs Assessment,
- discuss additional services/referrals needed,
- be given the form, STEP 2, Responsibilities of Mandatory Work-Eligible Recipients of Cash Assistance Programs – STEP Participation Requirements,
- be given the form, OFS DD1 IS, Direct Deposit/SVC Informational Sheet,
- discuss and arrange supportive services needed to participate in work activities, and
- continue to participate in an approved activity, if self-initiated.

The Intake Worker should explain the general components of FITAP, STEP, and other programs for which they may be eligible. Once the Needs Assessment has been completed and the client indicates which program he would like to apply for, the Intake Worker obtains eligibility information and performs all eligibility-related activities.

The Intake Worker must explain clearly to the work-eligible applicant that participation in the STEP program is a requirement to receive FITAP benefits. It is important that the applicant understands that he must participate in an approved employment or training activity for continued eligibility for FITAP and know that he has the option to choose STEP Supportive Service payments through Direct Deposit or Stored Value Card. At certification, the STEP 2 and OFS DD1 IS will be system generated and mailed to the client.

The Intake Worker should clearly explain that the goal of assistance is to help the applicant to become employed and to transition off of benefits within his 24-month time limit. After certification of FITAP benefits, the client will be referred to a STEP Case Manager located in the client's parish or region.

The Intake Worker will manually refer the applicant to the STEP program during the application period if the client needs to cure a STEP sanction. Work-eligible FITAP applicants will be automatically referred to the STEP program upon certification.

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Case Maintenance

The FITAP Case Maintenance Worker will perform ongoing eligibility-related activities for STEP and all associated programs. This includes processing redeterminations, SRs, and interim changes. The Case Maintenance Worker will coordinate with the STEP Coach to also process STEP Sanction Requests, Work Registration code changes, budgeting of earned income, approval or denial of time limit extensions, and establish incapacity determinations for clients who report a disability, incapacity, or an exemption if they are needed to care for a family member who is disabled or incapacitated.

STEP Case Management

The STEP Coach is responsible for ongoing case management for families who are striving toward becoming employed and moving toward self-sufficiency. This includes but is not limited to the following:

- Coaching the client to motivate and prepare them for educational and work activities, such as, but not limited to: defining their educational and work goals, learning how to overcome personal barriers, developing resumes and completing job applications, improving interpersonal skills, learning work ethics, identifying client interests that will lead to choosing an appropriate career/job, learning interview skills, identifying workplace supports and/or educating a client with disabilities to ask for reasonable accommodations on the job;
- Identifying appropriate Community Based Organizations and local businesses to provide work activities for clients. The Coach will assess the work force needs of the Community Based Organization and/or business and provide services and coaching that will enhance these skills in clients. Coaches will also continually assess Community Based Organizations and local businesses to assure work force needs have not changed and to ensure clients are properly matched in work activities;
- Working with applicants who need to cure a STEP sanction;
- Completing the Family Assessment ***;
- Completing the Family Success Agreement on certified FITAP families;
- Contacting the client to monitor progress;
- Following up with providers and employers;
- Arranging supportive services, including child care and transportation;
- Obtaining the client's preferred payment option and either enrolling the client in the SVC process or entering their Direct Deposit information in the system;
- Authorizing payment for all supportive services;
- Being knowledgeable about local or community resources, including educational and employment opportunities;
- Updating the Family Success Agreement;
- Ongoing assessment, follow-up, and problem resolution;
- Providing referrals to help meet the client's needs;
- Identifying innovative service solutions;

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- Requesting the FITAP worker to propose a STEP sanction for clients who fail to comply with STEP requirements;
- Entering participation hours; and
- Notifying the FITAP worker of needed changes on the client's FITAP case, such as work registration codes, address, phone number and new income or reduction/termination of income.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 2 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Participation Requirements

OFS 4FA [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) * Family Assessment **

OFS 4NA [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Needs Assessment

OFS DD1 IS [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Direct Deposit/SVC Informational Sheet

IV. REFERENCES

Code of Federal Regulations, Title 45: Parts 261, 262, 263, and 265

Reauthorization of TANF Final Rule [Federal Register: February 5, 2008 (Volume 73, Number 24)]
Act 58, 2003 Reg. Session.

[LAC 67: III. 5719](#)